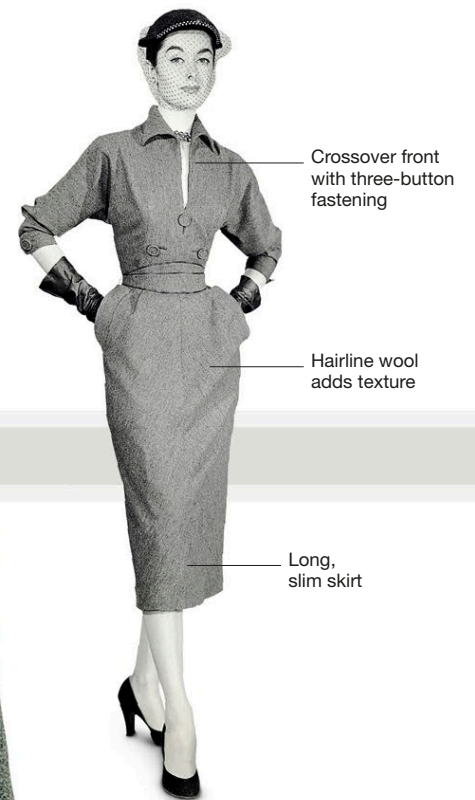




Chic grey Christian Dior displays both his dressmaking and tailoring skills in this grey wool ensemble, in which the focus is entirely on the upper body. An intricately panelled and draped jacket is set off against a plain, slim skirt.

1950



Slender lines The jacket of this hairline-striped wool suit by US designer Adele for Autumn/Winter 1952 is cut short to reveal the tiny waist. Dolman sleeves and diagonal-set hip pockets emphasize the model's shape.

Demure suit Worn to Ascot, this 1948 design creates a demure impression with its shawl collar, bow, grosgrain trim, and pleated skirt. The nipped-in waist and full skirt echo Dior's New Look.



1954

Parisian chic Despite the rise of fashion houses outside Paris, the city held on to its fashion credibility. Here, Audrey Hepburn starring in the 1954 film *Sabrina* plays a girl transformed into elegance by two years spent in the capital.



Curves This beautifully tailored wool suit by British designer Lachasse demonstrates an eye for detail. Following the line of the darts, flared panels sewn into the jacket bodice fall in layers over the hips to emphasize the sculpted curve.